

transform the same solution into an aid effectiveness and grant management platform.

InfoAxon's Indian experience was equally successful. HDFC Bank was one of its first customers in India. InfoAxon helped it move non-core banking applications running on various technologies onto a single platform, created using Red Hat, JBoss, etc. Other Indian clients soon followed—Yes Bank, the Indian Air Force, UNDP India, Castrol, Filex India, etc. Such long-standing relationships arising out of platforming gave InfoAxon a commercially viable business model.

Support and maintenance

The platforming model also gave rise to revenue opportunities from maintenance and support. InfoAxon has an OSS support/business continuity support centre that contributes 15 per cent of its business. "We provide support services for our core platforms and also are support partners for Red Hat, Enterprise DB, Pentaho, etc. About 80 per cent of our support services revenue comes from supporting our own platforms," says Nagar.

Custom development

While platforming is a reliable revenue generator for InfoAxon, it's the company's custom development expertise that won over people into those long lasting platforming partnerships. This amply demonstrates where a simple open

source customisation can lead to. "We also provide custom development services but use it more as a tactic to lead the client to the larger platforming package. And, we have won numerous clients with this strategy. For instance, we recently provided a customised e-learning solution for one of our UK customers. Now we are in talks with them to provide a knowledge repository attracting them to our platforming solution," says Dahiya. Today, the revenue generated from custom development is 15 per cent.

Scouting around for new opportunities

Looking ahead, sector-specific platforms and training are new pastures InfoAxon wishes to explore. "Based on our experience, we see a dearth of skilled resources. Most companies like us rely on home-grown talent. We are considering creating a training arm within our business to induct and train talent on our platforming solutions. Alongside, we are looking at knowledge intensive sectors like retail, pharma, media, advertising and manufacturing. We might work on more sector-specific platforms to address the rising knowledge and content concerns of these sectors," says Nagar. 

By: Vanisha Joseph

The author loves to experiment, and writing for *LINUX For You* is her latest experiment—so beware! Just a minute, she also happens to be a journalist during the day.



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